

U.S. strikes Iranian nuclear facilities

ATTACK MARKS ESCALATION OF CONFLICT

Trump promises ‘tragedy’ for Tehran if it retaliates

BY DAN LAMOTHE,
WARREN P. STROBEL
AND KAREN DEYOUNG

The U.S. military carried out sweeping strikes against Iranian nuclear facilities, President Donald Trump said late Saturday, marking a major escalation for his administration that tethers the United States directly to a conflict with no clear outcome or end in sight.

The president said in a social media post that U.S. warplanes had carried out a “very successful attack” on three sites, including the subterranean Fordow nuclear enrichment facility, a key target that Trump had openly deliberat-

ed striking for days.

“A full payload of BOMBS was dropped on the primary site, Fordow,” Trump said. “All planes are safely on the way home.”

At the White House later in the evening, Trump threatened more attacks on Iran if it decides to retaliate.

“This cannot continue,” Trump said. “There will be either peace, or there will be tragedy for Iran far greater than we have witnessed over the last days,” he added, referring in part to attacks that Israel has carried out on Iran.

Trump, flanked by Vice President JD Vance, Secretary of State Marco Rubio, and Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, said other tar-



CARLOS BARRIA/AP

President Donald Trump speaks from the White House alongside Vice President JD Vance, Secretary of State Marco Rubio and Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth.

gets will be easier to hit if the U.S. strikes again.

The president did not immediately say what kind of aircraft was used, but the strikes came after a fleet of B-2 Spirit bombers departed Whiteman Air Force Base in Missouri overnight Friday into Saturday, a U.S. official familiar with the issue said, speaking on the condition of anonymity because of the sensitivity of the issue.

The assault followed days of mixed messaging from the Trump administration.

The president had warned all of Tehran to evacuate, demanded the Iranian government’s “UNCONDITIONAL SURRENDER” and threatened that its supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, would be targeted unless demands were met. Trump shifted again Thursday, saying he would wait as long as two weeks before

deciding to attack, apparently signaling that he was intent on giving more time for diplomacy to work.

While the U.S. and Iran have fought deadly proxy battles for nearly a half-century in Lebanon, Yemen, the Strait of Hormuz and elsewhere, Trump’s action was the first significant U.S. military strike on Iranian soil since the 1979 overthrow of the U.S.-backed Shah of Iran, Mohammad Reza Pahlavi.

Trump’s decision to enter the conflict raises immediate questions about how Iran or its proxies may react, even as scores of Israeli strikes have left Iranian military capabilities diminished. Iran has threatened to retaliate against U.S. troops, tens of thou-

SEE IRAN ON A11

The Sunday Take: Trump hits hard, and world waits for what’s next. **A2**

Trump’s face on a \$250 bill? GOP is itching to hail its hero.

BY JOE HEIM

Late last month, Florida Republican Rep. Greg Steube introduced a bill that would halt any funding for the Washington Metropolitan Area Transportation Authority unless its name was changed. Steube, whose southwest Florida district is about 950 miles from Washington, proposed WMATA be rechristened the Washington Metropolitan Authority for Greater Access or ... WMAGA.

The legislation also called for Metrorail, the system’s flagship rail line, to be renamed the “Trump Train.”

The bill, Steube said in a statement, would signal a “cultural shift away from bureaucratic stagnation toward public-facing excellence and patriotism.”

Steube’s proposal is just the latest in legislative offerings this year paying tribute to President Donald Trump. House Republicans have proposed at least eight bills since January to honor the president or burnish his image. They would, among other things, put Trump’s portrait on U.S. currency, carve his face onto Mount Rushmore, rename Washington Dulles International Airport for him and make his birthday a national holiday. Two bills, both introduced by Rep. Marjorie Taylor Greene (R-Georgia), called for the House to expunge Trump’s impeachments in 2019 and 2021.

Longtime political observers say the GOP’s legislative love fest for the president is well outside of congressional norms. While members have often proposed legislation that honors presidents, it is almost never while they are still in office.

“It is unprecedented and to be honest with you, it’s completely

SEE BILLS ON A15

Abandoned by Trump, a farmer and a migrant search for a better future



BY JOHN WOODROW COX, SARAH BLASKEY AND MATT MCCLAIN IN KIRK, COLORADO

There was a saying he’d heard, about how every farmer rooted for all the other farmers to do well, too, until one of those others started farming next door. So JJ Ficken didn’t talk much about the grant money with other farmers.

But his bills had mounted, and his ambitions had unraveled, and in Kirk, a town of 61, it was easy to feel alone. Now on that afternoon in mid-April, JJ, 37, unstrapped the bags of seed corn on his trailer for a customer.

“How are ya?” JJ said, extending his hand to a man he’d known all his life. They’d played ball together, shared in family trips. So JJ decided to tell him.

The federal government had promised JJ a \$200,000 grant, spread across two years, to cover the cost of a seasonal farmhand from Latin America. In a place where local, legal help was nearly impossible to keep, the extra worker would give him the freedom to handle more jobs

and invest in his own equipment. It was an opportunity that could transform his family’s future, but, JJ explained to his friend, President Donald Trump had frozen the money.

“Good,” the man said, grinning. “Too much spending here and there. I’m okay with a little hurt.”

JJ took a breath.

“It needed to be done,” JJ said, softly, because he was also a Republican who, like nearly every farmer he knew, thought the country wasted too much money.

“But not all of it,” JJ said, because he rejected the notion that his grant was a waste.

“I guess,” JJ said, because he didn’t want to argue.

Hurt was something JJ already understood. It had been part of the landscape long before Trump took office. JJ was an American farmer, perpetually subject to weather, labor,

SEE FARMING ON A12

JJ Ficken, a fourth-generation farmer who had his federal grant money frozen, prepares to plant corn in April in Kirk, Colorado, a town of 61.

MATT MCCLAIN/THE WASHINGTON POST

President takes on Watergate safeguards

Measures to prevent another Nixon targeted amid massive ethics shift

BY NAFTALI BENDAVID

Then-Rep. Elizabeth Holtzman was 32 when, as a member of the House Judiciary Committee, she voted in 1974 for three articles of impeachment against President Richard M. Nixon. She spent the next few years as part of a Congress that passed wave after wave of laws to rein in future presidents.

A half-century later, Holtzman, a New York Democrat, is watching as President Donald Trump takes aim at post-Watergate reforms on transparency, spending, conflicts of interest and more. By challenging and disregarding, in letter or in spirit, this slew of 1970s laws, Trump is essentially closing the 50-year post-Watergate chapter of American history — and ushering in a new era of shaky guardrails and blurred separation of powers.

“We didn’t envision this,” Holtzman said. “We saw Nixon doing it, but he hadn’t done it on this vast a scale. Trump is saying, ‘Congress cannot tell me what to do about anything.’”

In 1976, for example, Congress created a 10-year term for FBI directors; Trump has forced out two FBI directors. The Impoundment Control Act of 1974 aimed to prevent presidents from disman-

SEE ETHICS ON A16

Social Security: Wait times, other metrics are no longer reported. **A3**



GERALD EICHSTÄDT AND SEAN DORAN/NASA/SWRI/MSSS

Ammonia-rich clouds swirl in the outermost layer of Jupiter, whose weather patterns scientists liken to Earth’s, in an image using data from NASA’s Juno spacecraft in 2018.

Otherworldly weather has a familiar spin

Experts see Earthlike hallmarks in Jupiter’s clouds, Martian storms

BY KASHA PATEL

What do the clouds on Jupiter, dust storms on Mars and rainstorms on Titan all have in common? They look like they belong on Earth.

As we venture through the universe, scientists are finding uncanny — and sometimes unexpected — hints of Earth on other planets and moons. Clouds on Jupiter swirl like ocean eddies on Earth, and dust storms that act like hurricanes can inundate Mars. Even though these celestial bodies can be

hundreds of million miles away from us, the same laws of physics apply, and what happens there can help us learn more about worlds that humans have yet to visit.

For decades, scientists have adapted Earth-based weather and climate models to study other atmospheres. These models draw on familiar physics equations known on Earth but contain tweaks for gravity, rotational speed or atmospheric pressure, for instance.

But by leveraging the sheer amount of knowledge and data

about our planet, scientists can get a head start on understanding the inner workings of storms or vortexes on other planetary bodies.

In some cases, the models provide almost everything we know about some otherworldly atmospheric processes.

“Our planetary atmosphere models are derived almost exclusively from these Earth models,” said Scot Rafkin, a planetary meteorologist at the Southwest Research Institute. “Studying the weather on other planets

SEE STORMS ON A6

METRO

With the tickets settled, the election season in Virginia is heating up.

BOOK WORLD

In Jayson Greene’s debut book, humans try to cure sorrow with technology.



TOP WORKPLACES

Winners say purpose and camaraderie are the must-haves for success.

BUSINESS

Customers are starting to push back against AI in their favorite products.



ARTS & STYLE

First, Virgil Abloh changed Nike. Then he came for luxury fashion.

TRAVEL

A beach day in Lagos, Nigeria: waves, grilled meat and an Afrobeat.

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